> In crisis, or worried about a Veteran? **Dial 988, then press 1**, or text 838255 — the Veterans Crisis Line, free and confidential, 24/7 (veteranscrisisline.net).

Which Benefit Am I On

FIND YOURS

I don't know which benefit I'm on

Has a VR&E counselor approved a plan for your degree?

Yes:

You're on VR&E · Chapter 31. Your counselor sends ODU the authorization (You don't file the clearance form.) · Plan, books, monthly money → your counselor · Your months left → your counselor (Chapter 31 isn't on VA's online check.) → *Your VR&E counselor (VRC)*

No:

Do you have a Certificate of Eligibility (COE) or award letter?

Yes:

The letter names your chapter. Look for "Chapter" and a number (33 Post-9/11 · 30 or 1606 Montgomery · 35 DEA. Fry says Fry.) · GI Bill letters also show months left · Then see what it pays (Pick "What does my benefit pay?")

No, or can't find it:

Check online, or by phone?

Online:

Your award letter names it. VA's check shows months left. Sign in on your own device to check what's left (It shows whether you have benefits left and how many months; it doesn't promise to name the benefit. To be sure which one, call VA.) · Applied for Post-9/11 on VA.gov, decided on or after Aug 20, 2022? (You can also download the decision letter. Family members request a copy through Ask VA.) → *VA Education Call Center, ODU's benefits office: Military Benefits & Certification Services*

By phone:

Call VA, or ask the benefits office. VA's call center tells you your chapter (Have your Social Security number ready.) · Or ask the benefits office what's been certified for you → *VA Education Call Center, ODU's benefits office: Military Benefits & Certification Services*

Not sure:

Your VA Regional Office can tell you. Ask for the VR&E Supervisor (They can say whether you have a Chapter 31 case.) · Or ask VA's Education Call Center which benefit is on file · No case? Come back and pick "No" → *Your VR&E counselor (VRC), VA Education Call Center*

Could I qualify for one I'm not using?

Which sounds most like you?

I have a VA disability rating:

10% or more, and not a dishonorable discharge? You may apply for VR&E. Apply on VA Form 28-1900 (A VA counselor decides entitlement.) · Other than honorable or bad conduct discharge? (VA may still find you eligible: ask about a discharge upgrade or a Character of Discharge review. A VSO helps for free.) · Using VR&E doesn't take months from your GI Bill → *Your VR&E counselor (VRC), An accredited Veterans Service Officer (VSO)*

Still serving, no rating yet:

Service members: VA Form 28-0588. At least one must be true (In the PEB process; in IDES; or expecting an other than dishonorable discharge with a VA memorandum rating of 20% or more.) · Severely injured on active duty? VR&E can start before a rating (VA says so on its how-to-apply page. Otherwise, if none fits, a VSO can help with the claim first.) → *An accredited Veterans Service Officer (VSO)*

I served on active duty after 9/10/2001:

Post-9/11 GI Bill · VA Form 22-1990. Discharged? It must be honorable (VA decides eligibility from your service record.) · 90 days or more pays a tier (100%: 36 months; a Purple Heart on or after Sep 11, 2001; or 30 continuous days with a service-connected disability discharge.) · Apply online → *VA Education Call Center*

I paid into the Montgomery GI Bill, or I'm in the Selected Reserve:

Montgomery GI Bill · Chapter 30 or 1606. Paid in on active duty → Chapter 30 (Generally 2 years or more. VA has four categories.) · 6-year Selected Reserve obligation → Chapter 1606 · Apply on VA Form 22-1990 → *VA Education Call Center*

I'm the child or spouse of a service member or Veteran:

Did the service member die on or after September 11, 2001, in the line of duty, or from a service-connected disability within 120 days of leaving active duty?

Yes:

Fry Scholarship, and maybe DEA. Fry pays at the Post-9/11 100% level (Tuition to the school; housing and books to you. For this year's amounts, pick "What does my benefit pay?") · Apply on VA Form 22-5490 · Also eligible for DEA? Rules depend on who you are (A spouse picks one for good. A child whose parent died in the line of duty before Aug 1, 2011 may use both, one at a time, up to 81 months; on or after that date, both only with a separate DEA event, capped at 48 months combined. Getting DIC as a child? Starting Fry or DEA ends those payments. Ask VA before choosing.) → *VA Education Call Center*

No, or it's a disability, missing or captured:

DEA · Chapter 35 · VA Form 22-5490. VA lists six routes (Includes a Veteran permanently and totally disabled from a service-connected disability.) · Not sure it fits? Apply. VA decides. (A child getting DIC gives those payments up when DEA starts.) → *VA Education Call Center*

WHAT IT PAYS

What does my benefit pay?

Which benefit?

Post-9/11 GI Bill or Fry:

Tuition to ODU, housing and books to you. Tuition and fees → ODU, at the in-state rate (Your tier sets the share. Fry pays at the 100% level.) · Housing: about $2,430 a month at ODU's main campus (At 100%, full time, with an in-person class that runs the whole term; first used on or after Jan 1, 2018 (earlier users can get a slightly higher rate). A shorter in-person session can change it: use the planner. All online: up to $1,198 (VA's Fry and transferred-benefit rates pages still say $1,261; ask VA which applies). None on active duty, or for a spouse on transferred benefits while the Veteran serves.) · Books: up to $1,000 a year at 100% ($41.67 a credit, times your tier.) → *VA Education Call Center, ODU's benefits office: Military Benefits & Certification Services*

VR&E:

Your plan's costs, plus a monthly allowance. Tuition, fees, books, supplies → paid for you (Under the plan your counselor approves.) · Full time: $837.23 no dependents · $1,038.49 one dependent · $1,223.79 two (+$89.18 each more. Half time pays too.) · Or the Post-9/11 housing rate, if you're eligible and elect it → *Your VR&E counselor (VRC)*

Montgomery, Active Duty:

Did you serve at least 3 continuous years on active duty?

Yes, 3 years or more without a break:

$2,601.00 a month, full time. Paid to you; you pay ODU · Less at ¾ or ½ time (ODU's certifying officials certify your band.) · On active duty: this rate or your tuition and fees, whichever is less → *ODU's benefits office: Military Benefits & Certification Services*

Between 2 and 3 years:

$2,110.00 a month, full time. Paid to you; you pay ODU · Less at ¾ or ½ time (ODU's certifying officials certify your band.) · On active duty: this rate or your tuition and fees, whichever is less → *ODU's benefits office: Military Benefits & Certification Services*

Neither, or I'm not sure:

VA decides which Montgomery table, if any, is yours. Check your award letter, or call VA (It names your table and your monthly rate.) · The benefits office can find out what ODU reports → *VA Education Call Center, ODU's benefits office: Military Benefits & Certification Services*

Montgomery, Selected Reserve:

$508.00 a month, full time. Paid to you; you pay ODU · Less at ¾ or ½ time; $127.00 below half (ODU's certifying officials certify your band.) → *ODU's benefits office: Military Benefits & Certification Services*

DEA:

$1,621.00 a month, full time. Paid to you; you pay ODU · Less at ¾ or ½ time (ODU's certifying officials certify your band.) → *ODU's benefits office: Military Benefits & Certification Services*

Yellow Ribbon or the STEM Scholarship:

Which add-on?

Yellow Ribbon:

Can cover some or all of the tuition above the Post-9/11 cap. For Post-9/11 at 100%, or Fry · ODU takes part, but only for some programs and degree levels (ODU sets which ones, how much, and how many students. Ask the benefits office before counting on it.) → *ODU's benefits office: Military Benefits & Certification Services*

Rogers STEM Scholarship:

Up to 9 more months or $30,000. For Post-9/11 or Fry students near the end of entitlement (In a qualifying STEM program.) · Tuition to ODU first, then books and housing → *ODU's benefits office: Military Benefits & Certification Services*

Will I get the Post-9/11 housing allowance?

Are you on active duty, or a spouse using transferred benefits while the Veteran is on active duty?

Yes:

No housing while you, or the Veteran whose benefits you use, serve on active duty. Tuition and fees are still paid · It can start once that service ends (Yours, or for a spouse on transferred benefits, the Veteran's. Tell the benefits office; a change in duty status needs a new clearance form.) → *ODU's benefits office: Military Benefits & Certification Services*

No:

More than half time?

Yes, in full-term classes:

Is at least one class in person?

Yes, and it runs the whole term:

Yes, at the ZIP rate for where you attend. About $2,430 a month at ODU's main campus (At 100%, full time; first used on or after Jan 1, 2018 (earlier users can get a slightly higher rate).) · Scaled by your credits and your tier (The planner works out your term, including short in-person sessions.) → *ODU's benefits office: Military Benefits & Certification Services*

Yes, but only a shorter session:

Shorter sessions: let the planner measure it. Enter your sessions and credits in the planner (It converts each session and checks "more than half time".) · ODU's certifying officials certify which standard applies → *ODU's benefits office: Military Benefits & Certification Services*

All online:

Yes, at the online rate: up to $1,198. Half the national average (Aug 1, 2026 to Jul 31, 2027.) · An in-person class that runs the whole term can lift it to the campus rate (ODU's rule. The planner works out your own term.) · VA's pages differ on this figure (Its Fry and transferred-benefit rates pages still say up to $1,261; its Post-9/11 rates page, updated Oct 13, 2026, says $1,198. Ask VA which applies to you.) → *VA Education Call Center, ODU's benefits office: Military Benefits & Certification Services*

I have 8-week sessions, or I'm not sure:

Shorter sessions: let the planner measure it. Enter your sessions and credits in the planner (It converts each session and checks "more than half time".) · ODU's certifying officials certify which standard applies → *ODU's benefits office: Military Benefits & Certification Services*

Half time or less, full-term classes only:

No housing at half time or less. Exactly half is not "more than half" · You need more than half: one more credit past half time can do it (At 12 for full time, 7 credits clears it and 6 doesn't. Check with the benefits office first.) → *ODU's benefits office: Military Benefits & Certification Services*

What counts as full time at ODU?

Which are you?

Undergraduate:

12 credits in fall, spring or summer. Shorter sessions are converted by VA (The planner does that arithmetic.) · ODU's certifying officials certify which standard applies → *ODU's benefits office: Military Benefits & Certification Services*

Graduate on campus, or doctoral or EdS:

9 credits across the full term. 16-week and 8-week classes add together · ODU's certifying officials certify which standard applies → *ODU's benefits office: Military Benefits & Certification Services*

ODUGlobal master's:

4.5 credits in one eight-week term. Counted per eight-week term, not the semester · ODU's certifying officials certify which standard applies → *ODU's benefits office: Military Benefits & Certification Services*

CHOOSING AND SWITCHING

VR&E or the GI Bill: what's different?

What do you want to compare?

Getting in:

A rating and a counselor, versus service time. VR&E: a 10%+ rating lets you apply (A VA counselor decides, and approves your plan.) · GI Bill: your service sets it (You pick an approved program; no counselor.) → *Your VR&E counselor (VRC), ODU's benefits office: Military Benefits & Certification Services*

What each pays:

VR&E can cover more of your approved costs. VR&E: tuition, fees, books, supplies, equipment (Plus a monthly allowance that grows with dependents, or the Post-9/11 rate if you choose it, have at least 1 day of Post-9/11 entitlement left and are within your GI Bill eligibility period: VA says "In most cases, the GI Bill rate is higher." Half time is paid.) · Post-9/11: tuition to the in-state cap, plus a books stipend (Housing only above half time. Current amounts: VA's rates page.) → *Your VR&E counselor (VRC), ODU's benefits office: Military Benefits & Certification Services*

Using both:

Use VR&E first if you can. VR&E doesn't take months from your GI Bill (But months used first under another VA education program can come off VR&E, unless VA grants retroactive induction.) · GI Bill benefits cap at 48 months combined (VR&E isn't counted.) → *Your VR&E counselor (VRC)*

Can I switch, or use two benefits?

What are you thinking of?

Montgomery and Post-9/11 both:

Your earlier choice may not be final. VA reviews files itself (You don't have to ask.) · Ask VA before revoking (Revoking can cost a kicker: extra money from your service on top of Montgomery, sometimes called a college fund.) · Combined limit: 48 months, not at the same time → *VA Education Call Center, An accredited Veterans Service Officer (VSO)*

Moving to VR&E:

Next term, not mid-term. Talk to your counselor before the term starts · Tell the benefits office too → *Your VR&E counselor (VRC), ODU's benefits office: Military Benefits & Certification Services*

Leaving VR&E for the GI Bill:

Next term, and the counselor first. Talk to your VR&E counselor before the term starts (A mid-term change isn't allowed. Ask them about retroactive induction too.) · VR&E time doesn't come off your GI Bill · Then ODU's certifying officials certify the GI Bill (Apply first if you never have.) → *Your VR&E counselor (VRC), ODU's benefits office: Military Benefits & Certification Services*

Another GI Bill chapter:

Often a one-time choice. Ask before you choose. One service period starting on or after Aug 1, 2011: often one choice, for good (VA: choose MGIB-AD and "you can't switch at some later date to use the Post-9/11 GI Bill." Perkins: a single period of sufficient length can qualify for both.) · Two or more periods: Rudisill may apply (VA reviews files itself.) · A change of chapter needs a new ODU clearance form → *VA Education Call Center, ODU's benefits office: Military Benefits & Certification Services*

WHO TO ASK

Who do I ask about what?

What's it about?

My enrollment or school paperwork:

The School Certifying Official. Certifies your enrollment each term (Plus the clearance form, drops, in person or online.) · Doesn't decide your benefit or rating → *ODU's benefits office: Military Benefits & Certification Services, ODU Military Connection Center*

A payment, a debt, or months left:

VA, by phone or in writing. Payment status, months left, letters, debts · Want it in writing? Use Ask VA (Name the school and term dates.) → *VA Education Call Center, Ask VA, in writing*

My VR&E plan:

Your VR&E counselor. Plan, authorizations, books, allowance, switching · Can't reach them? The Regional Office's VR&E Supervisor → *Your VR&E counselor (VRC)*

My rating or a claim:

An accredited Veterans Service Officer. Claims, ratings and appeals (A rating is the doorway to VR&E.) · Always free → *An accredited Veterans Service Officer (VSO)*

Every answer's sources and contact details are on the page itself, at the address below.

Not an official VA document and not a VA decision. Every figure is quoted from VA or ODU with its source and dates one tap away. VA's award governs your case, ODU's certifying officials' certification governs your enrollment, and your VR&E counselor governs anything Chapter 31. Post-9/11 figures run to Jul 31, 2027; the others to Sep 30, 2027.

Public address of this page: ferrelldevin.github.io/veteran-resources/education/odu-benefits-kit/benefit/

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